

FIRST MEAL.

Breaking the fast with Intention — protein, timing, and a clear start to the day.

The first real meal sets a tone. It can stabilise energy and begin the day's protein total, or it can be an afterthought that leaves you chasing hunger and caffeine until mid-afternoon. This sheet is not a breakfast dogma. It is a practical cue: when you do eat first, make it count.

WHY IT MATTERS

Insulin sensitivity is generally better earlier in the waking day for most people. A meal with clear protein early helps the daily total and often steadies appetite later.

You do not have to eat the moment you wake. You do benefit from the first meal being deliberate rather than accidental.

A SIMPLE TEMPLATE

Include a protein source you actually like — eggs are an easy default.

Add something that satisfies so you are not ravenous an hour later.

Repeat it on ordinary days. Novelty is optional; consistency is not.

Boring and done beats interesting and skipped.

× COMMON FOLLY

- × **Coffee as the first meal.** Caffeine can wait. Starting the day on stimulant alone often postpones real fuel and amplifies later crashes.
- × **Waiting until you are over-hungry.** Extreme hunger produces extreme choices. A planned first meal is quieter and more reliable.
- × **Perfect breakfast theatre.** If the meal only happens when you have forty free minutes and five ingredients, it will not survive a normal week. Simplify until it is automatic.

PRACTICAL LEVER

For fourteen days, put a clear protein source in the first real meal. Same-ish time when you can. Notice energy until lunch and how easy the rest of the day's food feels.

TIED TO THE CLOCK

First meal is one place circadian awareness and protein awareness meet. You do not need a stopwatch. You need the meal to exist and to carry protein.

Next step: Decide tomorrow's first meal tonight. Include protein. Repeat for two weeks. Free programme at beinghaware.github.io/BHAFL.